



From mud to **museum**

I was found buried
in a swamp in China.



Museums are amazing places full of **fossils** and **prehistoric treasures**. But have you ever wondered how fossils get there?



1 A dinosaur dies and is buried in the Earth. Over millions of years, it becomes a fossil. Years later the fossil is discovered.



2 Palaeontologists start working to excavate (dig out) the fossil with tools. The fossil is coated in plaster to protect it.



3 The palaeontologists take detailed photographs and sketches of everything. These records will be very useful to study later on.

The excavation process can take several months.

